

Who Wins the World Cup?

10,000 SIMULATIONS
48-TEAM TOURNAMENT

A Monte Carlo simulation of the 48-team tournament, driven by World Football Elo ratings and xG-adjusted match outcomes.

TITLE FAVOURITE

Spain

21.7% to win

CLOSEST CHALLENGER

Argentina

20.7% to win

FIELD

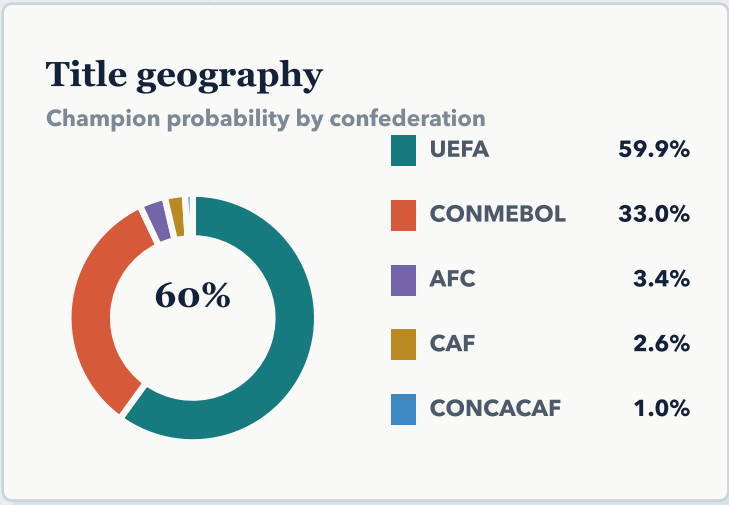
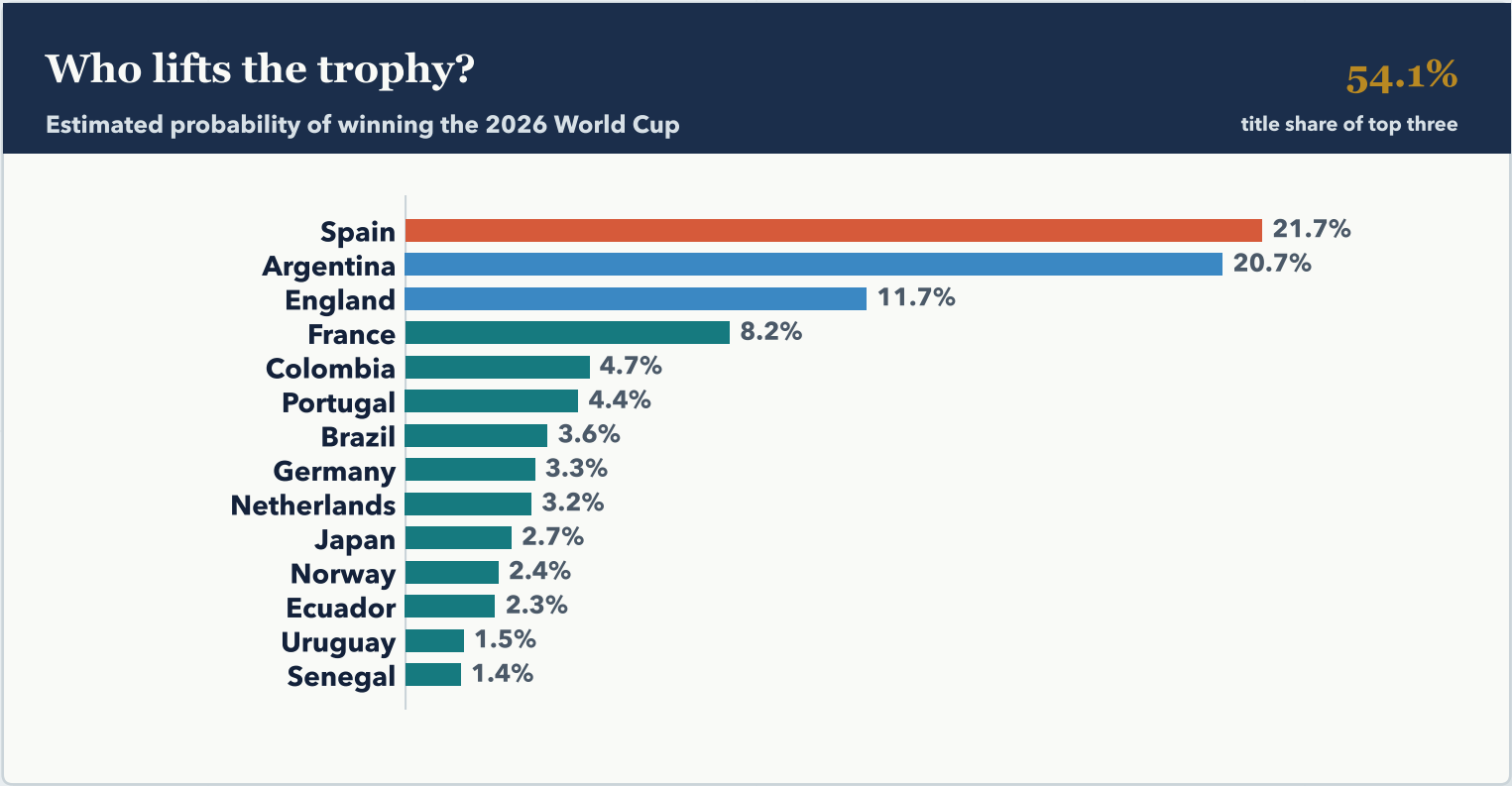
48 teams

12 groups of four

SIMULATIONS

10,000

as of June 9, 2026



The Path Through the Bracket

STAGE SURVIVAL
TOP 14 TEAMS

Each team's chance of surviving to the round of 16, quarter-finals, semi-finals, final and title.

Knockout pressure map					
Probability of reaching each stage. Darker means more likely.					
SURVIVAL					
round-by-round odds					
	Round of 16	Quarter	Semi	Final	Win
1 Spain	76%	56%	46%	33%	22%
2 Argentina	70%	59%	44%	31%	21%
3 England	72%	52%	35%	20%	12%
4 France	70%	47%	30%	16%	8.2%
5 Colombia	60%	36%	19%	10.0%	4.7%
6 Portugal	60%	35%	19%	9.7%	4.4%
7 Brazil	59%	35%	19%	8.5%	3.6%
8 Germany	62%	33%	18%	7.6%	3.3%
9 Netherlands	55%	34%	17%	7.5%	3.2%
10 Japan	51%	31%	15%	6.8%	2.7%
11 Norway	53%	28%	14%	5.7%	2.4%
12 Ecuador	56%	28%	14%	6.0%	2.3%
13 Uruguay	38%	21%	11%	4.4%	1.5%
14 Senegal	45%	22%	9.9%	4.0%	1.4%

Group favourites			
Two most likely sides to advance from each group.			
GROUP A	GROUP B	GROUP C	GROUP D
Mexico 47%	Switzerland 60%	Brazil 59%	Turkey 45%
South Korea 39%	Canada 48%	Morocco 43%	Paraguay 34%
GROUP E	GROUP F	GROUP G	GROUP H
Germany 62%	Netherlands 55%	Belgium 56%	Spain 76%
Ecuador 56%	Japan 51%	Iran 25%	Uruguay 38%
GROUP I	GROUP J	GROUP K	GROUP L
France 70%	Argentina 70%	Colombia 60%	England 72%
Norway 53%	Austria 26%	Portugal 60%	Croatia 44%

Does the Model Actually Work?

HISTORICAL REPLAY
NO HINDSIGHT

Backtests replay each past tournament from its pre-tournament ratings and score the forecast.

Backtested under pressure

3 TOURNAMENTS

Re-running the model with pre-tournament ratings only – no hindsight.

2014 • 2018 • 2022

WORLD CUP	ACTUAL CHAMPION	PRE-TOURNAMENT ODDS	RANK
2014	Germany	18.1%	#3
2018	France	5.7%	#5
2022	Argentina	21.8%	#2

Receipts

#3.3

average pre-tournament rank
the model gave the eventual winner

3/3

champions the model placed
inside its top five favourites

0.038

mean calibration error
(predicted vs. observed rates)